

Family Conversation Starters

FILL IN TOGETHER

Twenty questions that open a real conversation about the future, for families where "so, have you thought about college?" has stopped working.

When: Any car journey longer than twenty minutes

For the student

- ☐ What part of this whole thing are you most worried about?
- ☐ What do you wish I would stop asking you?
- ☐ If college were free, what would you study?
- ☐ What do you think you would be good at that nobody has suggested?
- ☐ Do you want to be near home, or far away? Be honest.
- ☐ What would make next year feel like a good year?
- ☐ Is there anything you have decided but not told me?

For the parent

The student asks these. It matters that it goes both ways.

- ☐ What are you actually afraid of here?
- ☐ What did you want to do at my age?
- ☐ How much can we really spend? I would rather know.
- ☐ What would you do if I did not go to college at all?
- ☐ What are you going to do when I leave?

Things we said we would come back to

WORTH KNOWING

- ◆ Side by side in a car beats face to face at a table for these conversations.
- ◆ If the answer is "I do not know", that is an answer. Do not fill the silence.
- ◆ Ask one question, not seven.